

At that moment, Vastarr Roaringhorn, brother of one of Gast's most vocal enemies in noble circles, and a group of hired toughs will enter the bar to avenge Lord Kuldos getting expelled from the Twilight Hunters for fighting. Vastarr has the intention of beating Gast, and anybody with him, to a pulp before the watch arrives to break it up.

Vastarr Roaringhorn; mh F7; AC 5; hp 63; THACO 14; Dmg 1d2+3 (fists), 1d6+3 (chair), 1d4+3 (bottle); XP 500

Toughs (6); mh F2; AC 8; hp 12; THACO 19; Dmg 1d2 (fists), 1d6 (chair), 1d4 (bottle); XP 35

This should not be a lethal fight but instead a good 'ole barroom brawl. Gast's and Urtos' action through the battle follow this event line; Gast will get hit from behind with a chair by Vastarr and be rendered unconscious. Urtos pick up a tough and throw him across the room into row of tables. Song, the wizardess barkeep will scream about wrecking her bar and will cast gust of wind, blowing a number of toughs out the front door. Urtos will grab another tough and with his superhuman strength he will throw him clear through the paneled wall while fighting him in a growing rage. Vastarr and the remaining toughs will back off at the sight of the blood and gore and will retreat in fear. Urtos, realizing that his rage is overtaking him and that the proximity to the full moon may allow his lycanthropy to awaken, will bolt out in the streets, the sun setting outside in a beautiful sunset.

4) The Thirsty Throat (D13)

The characters will hear the city watch coming down the street toward the Twilight Hunters Tavern and if they are to avoid arrest and a lengthy detention by the city, it is important that they leave the bar quickly and follow Urtos. The young lord will head back towards the docks and specifically to an old run-down establishment called the Thirsty Throat Tavern.

The Thirsty Throat Tavern stands next to Alek Lenter's Warehouses and has secret passages leading to these buildings as well as the sewer system below. It is a known hangout for thieves and cutthroats and definitely a suspicious place for Urtos to enter. If the characters enter the tavern behind him they will see that it is a two story dive decorated in mismatched tapestries all stained with heavy smoke. The air in the tavern is hot and grimy and a fat, sloth like barkeep keeps his patrons in line by smashing their heads in with a cudgel. Behind Bulaedo "Fists" Ledigleer, is his pet raccoon who stalks about the taproom picking patrons and the PC's pockets. Dark thieves whisper in the corner and the characters can watch drug deals and item fencing going on out in the open.

They will spot Urtos speaking to a group of three muscular, black haired thugs and a weasel-like man with a slight hunchback. The thugs are in reality the three werewolves that infected Urtos in the forest last summer, but he has been convinced by Alek Lenter, the weasel-like man, that these are fellow victims of the curse of lycanthropy. In his confused and lost mental state, Urtos has taken up running with these men during the full moon, stalking the depths of Ardeep Forest. Last month Urtos killed a young logger's son as his companions devoured the rest of the family. Urtos' conscience is worse than ever, but he would rather be in Ardeep forest when he changes to his evil wolf form than anywhere near his wife or the rest of Waterdeep.

After several minutes talking with the men, Urtos and them will leave the tavern and head for the south gates. Any attempt to stop or confront Urtos at this point will anger him and he will force his way out of the bar if need be. As the characters exit the bar, they will see that a full moon is rising in the

eastern sky and that it should be a well lit night. Urtos and his three mysterious companions will leave through the south gates and will turn into their lycanthropic wolf forms to run all the way to Ardeep Forest. Characters following them will notice that the group disappears into thin air over a hillock. Logical thinking by the characters, or Lythis' insistence upon their return to the estate, will lead them to traveling the several hours to hunting lodge at the edge of Ardeep Forest.

Ardeep Forest

1) Hunting Lodge (day or night)

This beautiful duskwood cabin is built on the fringe of the shadowy depths of Ardeep Forest. It seems to have seen a number of winters, but its walls and roof have resisted the elements well. A great set of stag antlers hang above the front door of the lodge and an outhouse can be seen in the distance. The front door of the lodge is locked and characters looking into the windows will see a darkened interior. Characters investigating a way to enter the lodge will be surprised by old Kharkos, the lodge butler, who is an accomplished ranger and will hold the characters at silver arrow point until they explain what they are doing here. Kharkos knows of Urtos' infliction and will protect his lord's secret to his death. If befriended, Kharkos will invite the characters inside the lodge and tell them this story;

Sorry, but I haven't seen Lord Phylund in over a ten-day. I think he was to travel down here sometime soon though, but I haven't seen him. If your friends of Lady Lythis, then your welcome to spend the night in the loft upstairs, but I'd warn you from poking around in the forest during the night. Ardeep is still a wilderness and many creatures still make it their home.

Kharkos will tell the characters little else, and will support the tale of events concerning last summer as did Gast. Allow the characters to search the premise for clues when Kharkos is asleep (night) or in the woods (day).

The following is a set of descriptions for the lodge;

1) Great Hall

This large living area has natural log walls and wooden furniture. A great stone fireplace dominates the northeastern wall and the room is decorated with a number of mounted animal heads. Thick and comfortable bearskin rugs cover the floor and the smell of wood smoke is strong here. There is a pile of books in the corner and several waterproofed cloaks near the door.

2) Butler's Room

This is Kharkos' sleeping chambers and the only item of interest is the silver dagger under his mattress.

3) Urtos' Bedroom

The door to this room is always locked and only Kharkos has the key. The mechanism is old though and can be easily forced. The bedroom is sparsely furnished and the bed seems unslept in. There is a good deal of mud on the windowsill on the western wall and this window's locking latch has been removed.

4) Closet

This closet is full of junk and debris piled atop more junk and debris. There are several sets of shredded clothes here, some smeared in blood. Observant characters will notice that one of these sets matches Urtos' clothing he wore on his journey outside the city. The blood on this set is still fresh. On a shelf in the closet's far reaches is a potion rack with a single potion of extra-healing within it.

5) Workshed

Tools and uncut logs litter this musty shed. The walls are full of holes on the forest side of the room and several small woodland creature scurry away as the party enters. There is a blood soaked mattress stuffed in the far corner of the room, thick golden animal fur dried to it in clumps.

6) Loft

This simple upstairs loft has only cots within it and a thick layer of dust covering everything.

7) Outhouse

This pungent smelling outhouse hasn't been dredged in some time and is quite ripe. Characters looking inside the privy hole or trying to find some clue here will be disappointed.

There is a clear trail leading into the woods behind the outhouse and a number of both human and animal tracks litter the forest floor along its length.

2) Dead Carcass (day or night)

Whether or not the characters follow the trail behind the outhouse during the day or the night, within about twenty minutes of hiking, they will find the carcass of a stag in a grove of blueleaf trees. The stag has been killed very recently by another animal and by examining the bones, the characters can discern that the predator was probably a large wolf due to the teeth marks and the power of its jaws.

3) Crazy Druid (day or night)

This should be an interesting encounter whether or not it is night or day. The characters will be following the trail deeper into the woods and will notice that the underbrush has become much heavier and small scrub-shrub bushes are now growing plentifully underneath the canopy of shadowtop trees. A figure will step out of the brush directly into the path of the characters and will surprise them. Read the characters the following;

A moment before, the path ahead of you was clear but now a wizened old man has stepped out from seemingly nowhere and blocks your movement into the wood. His robes are brown and tattered and his hair is tangled and full of brambles and thorns. The man carries a staff carved from duskwood and his right eye floats lazily in its socket. A slight pointedness can be seen in the man's ears, revealing a slight addition of elven blood. This hermit smiles at you silently and you watch as he reveals a set of yellowed and stained teeth, some missing.

"Ye be trespassing in me wood, cityfolk and ye shall be warned. The children of the night stalk these lands in shadow and threaten both man and

beast. The souls of the damned are offered no peace, no forgiveness. Stand against evil with the purity of light!"

The crazed druid will reach into his filthy robes and retrieve a +1 silver dagger and a quiver with 10 +1 silver-tipped arrows. He will mumbled to himself like a madman and then walk away into the brambles as they did not exist.

4) Peryton Attack (day or night)

Several hours after the druid encounter, the characters will catch glimpses of a shadow in the sky that keeps passing over the canopy above. Three perytons are stalking the characters and when the party is distracted or becomes aware of their presence, they will swoop down through the canopy and dive bomb the party. During the battle, one of the peryton should grab onto a character and fly south with him or her. The character will be left to his or her own in battling the beast in the air, but when it is killed, he or she will drop down a hidden shaft in the forest and land on a huge pile of decaying leaves at the entrance to a lost elven tomb.

Perytons (3); AC 7; MV 12, Fl 21; HD 4; hp 24 each; THACO 17; Dmg 4d4; +2 to attack on dive; need +1 to hit; XP 270

This battle should be tough for the characters realizing that few should have magical weapons of any sort. The perytons will retreat if brought to half their hit points and will regroup and try to stalk the party and attack at a more appropriate time.

5) Elven Tomb (day or night)

Characters following the direction of their kidnapped companion will undoubtedly found the entrance of the elven tomb surrounded in a field of thorn bushes and hidden in a steep ravine. The following are descriptions of the encounter areas in the tomb;

1) Entrance

Situated in the middle of a thick field of brambles and thorn bushes, a steep ravine cuts down into the earth and is filled with the dead leaf fall and debris of countless winters. From your position you can see that the ravine narrows toward its far end and that a natural cave entrance lies partially exposed behind a fallen tree trunk.

After clearing the tree trunk from the entrance, the characters will notice a number of elven runes carved into the natural stone wall near the entrance. The runes identify this place as the tomb of the elven warrior-hero Reluraun, last knight of the Fallen Kingdom. The tomb seems undisturbed and the air is stale and cold here.

2) Cave

The rough entrance continues into the earth in the form of a narrow, two foot wide tunnel that bends to the right and slopes downward. At times, the ceiling drops to a height of only a few feet, obviously the result of the soil above settling over the years. Eventually, the tunnel opens up into an arching cavern that bends around to your right. The skeletal remains of dozens of elven warriors lie in scattered heaps here, many of them still grasping their ancient

weapons. Your light source catches the gleam of metal and coins among the dead, and water has started to drip into pools from the ceiling.

The skeletons are not-undead as of yet, but will animate if Reluraun's remains are disturbed in area 3. Among the bones are seven still fine elven longswords, two sets of elven chainmail, and a wooden wand of magic missiles (2 charges) under the skull of one of the dead.

3) Pool

The cavern bends sharply back onto itself to an alcove in its farthest reaches. Here, the floor slopes down to a large pool of ice-cold ground water and a tiny stream falls from the ceiling and onto what looks to be a rectangular stone formation standing in the center of the pool.

The formation is in fact a stone coffin holding the remains of Reluraun, warrior-hero of the elves. The coffin has been covered in a layer of calcified rock that has precipitated out of the mineralized groundwater. Characters will have to chip through the stone to remove the lid of the warrior's resting place. When opened, the coffin will reveal the skeletal remains of an elven knight, his body clad in golden elven chainmail +1 and a long sword +2, dragonslayer (red dragons) on his chest whose hilt is carved in the likeness of two intertwined dragons with rubies for eyes.

When the coffin is opened, 12 skeleton guardians will rise from the remains behind the characters and attack the tomb robbers.

Skeletons (12); AC 7; MV 12; HD 1; hp 6 each; THACO 19; Dmg 1d6; 1/2 dmg from slashing, piercing weapons; XP 65

6) Logger's Cabin (night only)

This encounter will occur after the character leave the tomb and travel for an hour longer after they get back to the trail. The woods will begin to thin out ahead of the party and a small cabin will appear surrounded by an open stand of shadowtop trees. The cabins seems to in poor repair and the small garden next to it is overgrown and uncared for. The cabin has a single common room with a single door and three windows. The door is broken off its hinges and an examination of the area will uncover a number of clues.

First, a number of bloodstained are dried on the floor of the cabin and someone has place a now wilted bouquet of yellow snapdragons and violets in the center of the floor. Two of the three window in the cabin are shattered and dried blood can be found smeared on the glass. The door itself, if turned over, will show deep claw marks on the outside side and these can be matched to those on the floor and walls of the interior of the cabin. The footprints of large wolves can be found in the dried mud around the perimeter of the cabin.

This is a suitable place for the characters to camp for the night, and if they do so move directly to encounter 7. If it is night, then move directly to encounter 7 after the characters have investigated the area.

7) Wolf Attack (night only)

The characters will be awakened or startled by a low growl outside the cabin. Looking outside, they will see a number of shadowy shapes darting between the trees in the nights. Four sets of glowing feral yellow eyes will stalk the cabin and surround it on all sides. The werewolves (Urtos and his companions) will attack through the door and windows in their wolf forms only.

Werewolves (4); AC 5; hp 24, 28, 37, 30 (Urtos); THACO 15; DAM 2-8; +1 needed to hit, lycanthropy curse; shapechange; XP 420

The three werewolves will appear as large black haired wolves while Urtos' coat is a dirty golden color. The combat will be fierce and dangerous and the characters can use any creative ideas in combating the werewolves. On segment 20, Kharkos will arrive shooting silver arrows and coming through the front door of the cabin. He will stop any character trying to kill the golden wolf and the werewolves will flee at his approach.

Kharkos; mh R8; AC 4; hp 57; THACO 11; Dmg 1d6/1d6; longbow w/silver-tipped arrows

After the werewolves are driven off, Kharkos will inform the characters that a messenger has arrived at the lodge with a message from Lady Lythis that she has gone into labor and requests the party's presence back in the city.

Birth of Taernos

The characters will be escorted out of the woods by Kharkos, but by the time they arrive back at the Phylund Villa, the next afternoon, Lythis has already given birth to her son, Taernos. He is a beautiful and healthy (though cursed) baby boy and although Lythis is delighted with his birth, she will ask about Urtos immediately. As the characters try to explain what happened, they will be interrupted as Urtos enters the room dressed in a dirtied set of leathers and pushes past them. He will kiss his wife and apologize to her for not being there sooner. As he holds his son, Taernos, for the first time, characters will hear a commotion outside in the hall.

"You can't come in here, Lady Phylund is recuperating after giving birth, wait a moment!"

"Make way woman! Or you'll be arrested for interfering with the city guard!"

The commotion outside the bedroom continues and you watch as a number of armed city guards burst into the bedroom much to Urtos' and Lythis' surprise. The guards stand at attention with their hands on their blades and step away from the doorway to allow five black robed men to enter the room. The lead magistrate looks thoughtfully at the new parents of Taernos and then speaks solemnly, "Make way for one of the masked Lords of Waterdeep!"

The magistrates now step to the sides of the doors like the guards and there is a moment of confusion in the crowded bed chamber before a figure steps out of the shadows and through the doorway. Of indistinguishable build and height, the figure is dressed in a black robe that touches the floor and its hands are covered in thick black gloves. However, the most intriguing feature of the stranger is its head, one masked behind a polished silver mask that looks like a mirror which completely hides all traces of the figure's identity. With a low-gravely and obviously distorted voice, the masked Lord of Waterdeep raises his hand and points at the newly born child.

"By decree of the Lords of Waterdeep, I hereby proclaim Taernos Phylund, first son of Lord Urtos Phylund of the Phylund noble house, as an unfit heir to the holdings and fortunes of this estate. In addition, any subsequent offspring of Lord Phylund are similarly decreed unfit heirs. In accordance to the laws of this city, the title of heir to the Phylund fortunes is hereby given to the second son of the former Lord Phylund, Urtos the III, son of Aridarye Phylund. The Lords of Waterdeep have spoken."